



# Pocket of Calm

A guided journaling companion for small returns

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## **A note before you begin**

This book and deck are personal reflection tools. They are not therapy, medical care, diagnosis, crisis support, or a substitute for professional advice. Skip any prompt that does not fit; seek appropriate professional or urgent support when needed.

The boxed deck is optional. This paperback companion includes all 54 prompts as a stand-alone journal.

# **When a blank journal is too much, begin with one small question.**

Choose a prompt at random, start with the family that fits, or read one and close the book. There is no streak to keep and no right answer to find.

## How I want to use this

You can use this book in five minutes or over many months.

### PLACES I MAY KEEP THIS BOOK

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### PROMPTS OR MOMENTS I WANT TO RETURN TO

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### A SENTENCE I WANT TO PRACTICE

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**ARRIVE · CARD 01**

**Name three things in this room that make you feel a little more here.**

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

**DATE / MOMENT**

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**WHAT I NOTICE**

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**WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?**

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ARRIVE · CARD 02

**Let your eyes land on one ordinary object.  
What do you notice about it?**

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

**DATE / MOMENT**

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**WHAT I NOTICE**

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**WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?**

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ARRIVE · CARD 03

# Where is your body being supported right now?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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ARRIVE · CARD 04

## What sound is closest? What sound is farthest away?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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ARRIVE · CARD 05

**If you could give this moment a weather report, what would it be?**

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

**DATE / MOMENT**

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**WHAT I NOTICE**

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**WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?**

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ARRIVE · CARD 06

**Notice your hands. What are they doing, holding, or asking for?**

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

**DATE / MOMENT**

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**WHAT I NOTICE**

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**WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?**

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ARRIVE · CARD 07

**Name one thing that is true in this exact minute.**

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

**DATE / MOMENT**

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**WHAT I NOTICE**

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**WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?**

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ARRIVE · CARD 08

## What changes when you lengthen only the exhale, naturally and without force?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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ARRIVE · CARD 09

## What is one place you could make two inches more comfortable?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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SOFTEN • CARD 10

**What is one sentence you would rather hear  
than the one your inner critic is offering?**

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

**DATE / MOMENT**

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**WHAT I NOTICE**

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**WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?**

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**SOFTEN · CARD 11**

## **What would “kind enough” sound like here?**

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

**DATE / MOMENT**

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**WHAT I NOTICE**

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**WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?**

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SOFTEN • CARD 12

**What would you say to someone you love in this exact moment?**

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

**DATE / MOMENT**

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**WHAT I NOTICE**

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**WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?**

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**SOFTEN · CARD 13**

# What are you allowed to be learning?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

**DATE / MOMENT**

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**WHAT I NOTICE**

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**WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?**

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SOFTEN · CARD 14

## Which expectation could become a request instead?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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**SOFTEN • CARD 15**

# What deserves less judgment today?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

**DATE / MOMENT**

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**WHAT I NOTICE**

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**WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?**

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**SOFTEN · CARD 16**

# **What can be true without being fixed tonight?**

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

**DATE / MOMENT**

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**WHAT I NOTICE**

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**WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?**

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SOFTEN • CARD 17

## What is one thing you did that was quietly difficult?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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SOFTEN • CARD 18

## What would it mean to take your own side for five minutes?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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NOURISH · CARD 19

## What kind of comfort sounds possible, not perfect?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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NOURISH · CARD 20

## **What sensory cue might help: warmth, water, air, texture, quiet, or movement?**

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

**DATE / MOMENT**

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**WHAT I NOTICE**

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**WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?**

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NOURISH · CARD 21

## What would make the next hour five percent gentler?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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NOURISH · CARD 22

## What have you been needing but postponing?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

**DATE / MOMENT**

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**WHAT I NOTICE**

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**WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?**

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NOURISH · CARD 23

## What is one ordinary thing that helps you feel more like yourself?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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NOURISH · CARD 24

## If care were practical today, what would it look like?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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NOURISH · CARD 25

## What would a good-enough pause include?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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NOURISH · CARD 26

# What do you want less of around you right now?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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NOURISH · CARD 27

## What is one small pleasure you do not have to earn?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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REACH · CARD 28

## What kind of support would make this lighter to carry?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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REACH · CARD 29

# Who could receive one honest sentence from you?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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REACH · CARD 30

## What boundary would protect your next hour?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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REACH · CARD 31

## What question could you ask instead of trying to guess?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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**REACH · CARD 32**

# What task is not yours to solve alone?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

**DATE / MOMENT**

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**WHAT I NOTICE**

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**WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?**

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REACH · CARD 33

## What would a clear “not today” make room for?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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REACH · CARD 34

## Where could you ask for help before you are at capacity?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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**REACH · CARD 35**

## **What conversation needs a softer beginning?**

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

**DATE / MOMENT**

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**WHAT I NOTICE**

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**WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?**

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REACH · CARD 36

## What do you need someone else to understand about today?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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## What has been helping, even a little?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

**DATE / MOMENT**

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**WHAT I NOTICE**

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**WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?**

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## What did you do today that you almost failed to count?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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## Where did you choose a sustainable pace?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

**DATE / MOMENT**

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**WHAT I NOTICE**

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**WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?**

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CONTINUE · CARD 40

## What is one thing you have already survived or learned?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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CONTINUE · CARD 41

## What would make progress feel less like a scoreboard?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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## What is worth repeating tomorrow?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

**DATE / MOMENT**

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**WHAT I NOTICE**

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**WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?**

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## What part of your routine is quietly working?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

**DATE / MOMENT**

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**WHAT I NOTICE**

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**WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?**

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## What did you notice with curiosity instead of judgment?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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## What is one reason to trust your ability to continue?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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RESET • CARD 46

## If today needed to be smaller, what could become optional?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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## What is the next physical action—not the whole project?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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RESET • CARD 48

## What can wait until you have more information or energy?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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**RESET • CARD 49**

# What can you set down for ten minutes?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

**DATE / MOMENT**

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**WHAT I NOTICE**

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**WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?**

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RESET

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RESET • CARD 50

## What is one kind way to end this loop?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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RESET • CARD 51

## What needs a list, a timer, a glass of water, or a message?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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RESET

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RESET • CARD 52

## What would you like the next hour to feel like?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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RESET • CARD 53

# What is one decision you do not have to make right now?

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

DATE / MOMENT

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WHAT I NOTICE

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WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

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**RESET • CARD 54**

## **What would “enough for today” look like?**

*You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.*

**DATE / MOMENT**

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**WHAT I NOTICE**

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**WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?**

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*Choose a card, a memory, a feeling, or nothing at all.*

## Open reflection

*Choose a card, a memory, a feeling, or nothing at all.*

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## Open reflection

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